

The Project Charter

The one-to-three-page document that defines what the team is solving, who is involved, and what success looks like.

What It Does

Every Six Sigma project starts with a charter, and a good one does eight specific things. It states the problem and the goal in specific terms with numbers, names the customer, sets the scope, names the team and sponsor, estimates financial impact, lists the timeline, and captures known risks. A sharp charter creates a real project. A vague one creates a wandering one.

Sharp vs Vague

A manufacturing team worked six weeks with a problem statement that read only improve product quality. No product line, no baseline, no target. They produced nothing because their charter was a wish. After a rewrite naming the product, the Cleveland plant, a defect rate of forty-two thousand parts per million, and three hundred thousand dollars per quarter in cost, the next six weeks were finally productive.

Your Part In It

As a white belt, you do not write the charter. The green belt or black belt does. Your job is to receive it, decode it, and figure out exactly what you are being asked to contribute. That decoding skill is what you practice with AI.

Remember this

A charter that names the numbers builds a project; a charter that does not builds a wish.